

Gumtree (or whatever) and see what someone else is selling the item for.

Then list the item (only adults can do this legally, so use *your* ID):

- Take photos on your phone (the more the better).
- Set a realistic price based on what's currently on the market.
- Have your kids write up a description of the item—the more detailed and 'salesy' the better. This gives them a lesson in the language of advertising; if you learn how to write it, you learn how to resist it!

Depending on your child's age, you'll probably want to give your own phone number and deal with buyers yourself—however, this is your kids' project so consult them during the process. Either way, it's likely they'll end up selling their stuff for 90 per cent less than what you bought it for.

That in itself is an awesome lesson. And then there's the kicker . . .

Step 3: They get to buy something second-hand!

Your kids can use the money they get from selling their stuff to buy something else they want second-hand. While they're hunting down a bargain, get them to calculate what they're saving from the recommended retail price (RRP), to further ingrain the lesson.

A few points you'll want to keep in mind:

Little kids (under 7) may not really understand the idea of buying and selling. So I'd suggest you find a small toy they don't use, donate it to your local op-shop, and bring along their Splurge Jar to buy something they choose.

Tweens will get the idea of trading, but they may not be too keen to part with any of their stuff. But you don't want to raise hoarders. That's why, ahead of time, you should find at least one item you can suggest they trade, and explain they can swap it for something really cool.

Okay, so now it's time to get into one of the most memorable Money Meals you'll ever do.